

Medical
M-02 Abdominal Pain BLS

Revised 3/1/2000

PRIORITIES:

- ABCs
- Degree of distress? Shock?
- Assure an advanced life support response;
- History;
- Obtain a complete history and collect medications.

Abdominal Pain (NOT in Shock or Extremis)

Mild to moderate pain, able to be comfortable, no signs of shock.

1. Ensure a patent airway (suction as necessary)
2. Be prepared to support ventilation with appropriate airway adjuncts;
3. OXYGEN THERAPY - Begin oxygen at 6 liters/ minute by nasal cannula or 10 liters/minute by mask. If there is a history of Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD), observe for respiratory depression and support respirations as needed. **DO NOT** withhold oxygen from a patient in cardiorespiratory distress because of a history of COPD.
4. Position of comfort if conscious, usually on either side with knees drawn up;
5. Nothing by mouth;
6. Assist advanced life support personnel with patient packaging and movement to ambulance;
7. Consider:
 - Anticipate vomiting;
 - Cervical spine protection if indicated;
 - Avoid deep abdominal palpation.

Abdominal Pain (In Shock)

Moderately – severe to severe pain, restless, unable to find position of comfort unless absolutely still or signs of shock.

1. See Shock – Non Traumatic (Protocol c-1)

Gastrointestinal Bleeding

History of dark, tarry stools or vomiting blood; may or may not have abdominal pain. If in shock, see SHOCK.

1. See ABDOMINAL PAIN (Protocol m-1) listed above.

Medical M-02 Abdominal Pain

Priorities

Airway/Breathing/Circulation
Identify signs of shock
Treat cardiac dysrhythmias according to the appropriate protocol
Keep patient NPO
Early Transport
Early contact of receiving hospital

Stabilize Airway

Oxygen – Titrate to SpO₂ >95%

Cardiac Monitor

Consider IV/IO TKO
for severe pain

Hypotension Present?

NO

Yes

CONSIDER

Refer to M-04 Pain Management

IV/IO Access – Large bore and wide open

Recheck vital signs every NS 250mL until SBP >100 or until clinical condition improves

Consider second IV if appropriate

Contact Base Physician for
Additional Medication Orders

Transport

DISRUPTED COMMUNICATIONS

In the event of a "disrupted communications" situation where a base hospital physician CANNOT be contacted for orders, Solano County Paramedics MAY NOT utilize the portions of this protocol requiring base physician orders AND must transport to the closest receiving facility.